

Pooja Mahapatra

HR Professional · Talent Acquisition · Recruiter · Former Software Tester

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

HR & Talent Acquisition professional with 3+ years of prior experience in technology — software testing and development at Cognizant. Pivoted from engineering into Human Resources in 2025 and now owns end-to-end hiring for high-bar technical roles, from sourcing through to offer. Brings genuine technical fluency to recruiting — able to read a developer's résumé and a candidate's potential alike — alongside AI-powered workflows to hire smarter. Also builds recruitment tools and offers career-guidance services.

EXPERIENCE

Talent Acquisition

Nov 2025 – Present

Hireginie · Full-time · Remote

- Currently sourcing, screening and onboarding great talent, and meeting clients' requirements across high-bar technical and non-technical roles.

HR Team Manager

Oct – Dec 2025

Matriosh · Freelance · Delaware, United States (Remote)

- A stealth-mode startup studio building and scaling next-generation ventures; oversaw core people operations and multi-functional coordination across hiring, investor relations, and startup operations.
- Managed two active projects, working closely with the founding team to design end-to-end recruitment strategies, streamline operational processes, and facilitate communication between internal teams and external stakeholders.
- Bridged talent management, strategic execution, and organizational development within a fast-paced, innovation-driven environment.

HR Team Manager

Oct – Dec 2025

Soven Developer · Freelance · India

- Oversaw end-to-end recruitment for Indian interns — from sourcing and screening to interviews, onboarding, and performance tracking.
- Led and trained a team of HR interns to ensure smooth operations and effective coordination across departments.
- Focused on building efficient hiring processes, enhancing recruitment strategies, and fostering a positive, growth-oriented internship experience within Soven's dynamic, stealth-mode environment.

HR Intern

Sep – Oct 2025

Soven Developer · Mumbai

- Contributed to recruitment, onboarding, and HR operations, quickly ramping into ownership of the function.

HR Intern

Jul – Sep 2025

Websites.co.in · Mumbai

- Sole HR handling end-to-end recruitment and HR operations despite being an intern.
- Built a pipeline of 400+ candidates and facilitated the hiring of 20+ employees in just 2 months.
- Created Job Descriptions (JDs), assignments, and onboarding guidelines to standardize processes.
- Conducted resume screening, scheduling interviews, coordinating with managers, and final selections.
- Designed and implemented onboarding & training programs, ensuring smooth new-hire integration.
- Conducted market research (reki) to identify talent pools and improve outreach strategies.
- Established scalable HR workflows, operating at the level of a full-time HR professional.

Programmer Analyst → Associate

Aug 2021 – May 2024

Cognizant · Bengaluru

- Analysed client requirements and implemented solutions using Java, SQL and jBPM for backend validation, workflow automation, and system efficiency.
- Designed and executed test cases by tracing business-process flows and creating process models in BonitaSoft (later migrated to Red Hat) and Business Central.
- Executed both manual and automated testing — regression, functional, and performance — using Selenium and JUnit.
- Identified and fixed UI-related defects, ensuring a seamless user experience and stable interface performance.
- Drove defect analysis and resolution, achieving 85%+ code coverage and improving software reliability.
- Used Jenkins, Git, SonarQube, and JIRA for CI/CD, version control, code quality, and defect tracking respectively.
- Engaged in Agile ceremonies — daily stand-ups and sprint planning — to support team alignment and timely delivery.

Programmer Analyst Trainee

Mar – Jul 2021

Cognizant · Kolkata

- Received comprehensive training in Java, SQL, HTML, CSS, JavaScript, and Agile methodologies — hands-on across the software development lifecycle and testing practices.
- Built an Issue Tracker website from scratch using HTML, CSS, SQL, JavaScript, and Java.

INTERNSHIPS & EARLY EXPERIENCE

Intern

Sep – Oct 2019

Shrimann Superspeciality Hospital · Jalandhar

- Acquired in-depth knowledge of hospital departments and record-keeping procedures.
- Gained practical insights into medical equipment, including defibrillators and ventilators.

Intern

May – Jul 2019

KIMS (Kalinga Institute of Medical Sciences) · Bhubaneswar

- Hands-on experience handling and troubleshooting medical devices used in hospitals and healthcare units.
- Compiled a detailed report on the working principle and usage of an Ultrasound machine.

Event Coordinator

Oct 2017 – Mar 2018

Anamle Design Solutions · Odisha

- Helped organise and promote the event through social platforms.

PROJECTS

Empowering Home Automation for the Disabled

Lovely Professional University

- Demonstrated a smartphone app-controlled system for household appliances to assist the disabled, implemented with Arduino Uno, Bluetooth relay, and the C language.

A.R.M — Arduino Regulated Mayo Ware

Lovely Professional University

- Showcased muscle-sensing control for a dummy hand, utilizing Arduino Uno and IoT technology.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Java, C/C++, HTML, CSS, JavaScript, SQL.

Frameworks: Spring Boot, JUnit, jBPM.

Tools & Technologies: Selenium, SonarQube, Jenkins, JIRA, Git, GitHub, Maven, Microsoft Office.

IDEs: Eclipse, Visual Studio, Spring Tool Suite (STS).

Technical Environments: MySQL, BonitaSoft, Business Central, Red Hat Developer, Oracle.

Testing: Manual testing, automation testing, regression testing, test case design, defect tracking.

HR & TALENT SKILLS

Recruiting: Talent sourcing, candidate screening, end-to-end recruitment, onboarding, interview coordination, pipeline management.

Operations & People: HR operations, employer branding, stakeholder management, team leadership, process documentation.

Ways of working: AI tools & automation, communication, fast learning & adaptability.

EDUCATION

B.Tech, Biomedical Engineering

Lovely Professional University

2017 – 2021 · CGPA 8.0 / 10

10+2, CBSE

SAI International School

82%

10th, ICSE

SDA School, Khordha

80%

PARTICIPATIONS

Graduation Project Expo — Lovely Professional University

- **Empowering Home Automation for the Disabled** — demonstrated smartphone app-controlled household appliances, aiding the disabled; implemented with Arduino Uno, Bluetooth relay, and C language.
- **A.R.M — Arduino Regulated Mayo Ware** — demonstrated muscle-sensing control for a dummy hand, utilizing Arduino Uno and IoT technology.

106th Indian Science Congress — Lovely Professional University

Attended the conference, engaging with brilliant minds and cutting-edge research.

Workshop by Birmingham City University, UK

Participated in a workshop organised by the Faculty of Health, Education and Life Sciences, Birmingham City University, UK, in collaboration with the School of Bioengineering and Biosciences, Lovely Professional University.

Importance of Medical Equipment Testing & Calibration

Attended a conference organised by the Top Biomedical Device Learning Community of Engineers in collaboration with KLE College of Engineering & Technology, Belgavi, focusing on the significance of testing and calibration for medical equipment.

CERTIFICATIONS

- Claude 101 — Anthropic
- Strategies for External Recruiters — LinkedIn
- HR Recruiting Communication Strategies — LinkedIn
- Business Analyst
- Software Development Trainee
- Leading Healthcare Quality & Safety
- Nanotechnology & Nanosensors
- Basic Microbiology

LANGUAGES

English — Full Professional · **Hindi** — Native · **Odia** — Native

SERVICES OFFERED

1:1 Career Guidance & Coaching · Résumé / CV Review · Interview Preparation · LinkedIn Optimization · Tech Recruiting Advisory (for startups) · Early-Career Mentoring